

KYLE MAHOWALD

Department of Linguistics
The University of Texas at Austin

web: <https://mahowak.github.io>
email: kyle@utexas.edu

PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

Associate Professor with Tenure August 2026-
Assistant Professor 2021-2026
Linguistics, The University of Texas at Austin, Austin, Texas

Part-time Consultant 2025-2025
OpenAI, San Francisco, California [virtual]

Assistant Professor 2020-2021
Linguistics, University of California, Santa Barbara, Santa Barbara, California
Steering Committee Member & Affiliate Faculty, Cognitive Science Emphasis
Affiliate Faculty, Center for Responsible Machine Learning
Affiliate Faculty, Center for Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences

Postdoctoral Researcher 2019-2020
Computer Science, Stanford University, Palo Alto, California
Advisors: Dan Jurafsky, Daniel McFarland

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Brain and Cognitive Sciences 2016
Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, Massachusetts
Thesis: *Cognitive and Communicative Pressures in Natural Language*
Advisor: Edward Gibson

M.Phil., General Linguistics and Comparative Philology (with Distinction) 2011
Oxford University, Oxford, United Kingdom
Thesis: *An LFG Approach to Old English Constituent Order*
Advisor: Mary Dalrymple

A.B., English (*summa cum laude*) 2009
Harvard University, Cambridge, Massachusetts
Thesis: *A Fairy's Tale: Queen Mab's Journey from Shakespeare to Modernity*
Advisor: Marjorie Garber

Algorithm Developer
Hudson River Trading, New York City, New York

2016-2019

Google Scholar Profile: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=XUmFLVUAAAAJ&hl=en>

AWARDS AND HONORS

- 2025 Outstanding Paper Award, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP) 2025 for “Causal interventions reveal shared structure across English filler-gap constructions” [8 Best/Outstanding out of 8,174 submitted]
- 2025 Senior Area Chair Highlight, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP) 2025 for “Constructions are revealed in word distributions” [35 out of 8,174 submitted]
- 2025 American Psychological Association Editor’s Choice Article for “Intrinsically memorable words have unique associations with their meanings”. [From APA: “Editor’s Choice papers represent the best science in each area of our discipline, reflecting science that is exceptionally important, impactful, and deserves additional visibility for the whole field.”]
- 2024 Outstanding Paper Award, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP) 2024 for “Language models learn rare phenomena from less rare phenomena: the case of the missing AANNs” [25 Best/Outstanding out of 6,105 submitted]
- 2024 Best Paper Award, Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) 2024 for “Mission: impossible language models” [5 awarded out of over 4,407 papers submitted to conference]
- 2024 National Science Foundation CAREER Award
- 2023 Outstanding Paper Award, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP) 2023 for “Revisiting the optimality of word lengths” [30 Best/Outstanding of 4,909 submitted]
- 2012-2015 National Defense Science and Engineering Graduate Fellowship
- 2014 Angus MacDonald Award for Excellence in Undergraduate Teaching, MIT
- 2009-2011 Marshall Scholarship [1 of 40 selected nationally]
- 2009 Harvard Bowdoin Prize (Best Undergraduate Essay), \$10,000
- 2008 Harvard Phi Beta Kappa Junior Electee [1 of 24 elected as a Junior]

PUBLICATIONS AND SCHOLARLY/CREATIVE WORKS

*Asterisk indicates equal contribution by starred authors (either co-first authors or co-senior authors).

Articles

- [1] D. Drucker, **K. Mahowald**. 2026. The Counterexample Game: Iterated Conceptual Analysis and Repair in Language Models. In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Volume 48 (2026).
- [2] S. Boguraev, Q. Yao, **K. Mahowald**. 2026. France or Spain or Germany or France: A Neural Account of Non-Redundant Redundant Disjunctions. In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Volume 48 (2026).
- [3] C. R. Jones, A. Lombardi, **K. Mahowald**, B. K. Bergen. 2026. LLMs and People Both Learn to Form Conventions—Just Not with Each Other. In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Volume 48 (2026).
- [4] R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**. 2026. Futrell R, Mahowald K. How linguistics learned to stop worrying and love the language models. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*. 49:e198. doi:10.1017/S0140525X2510112X [target article]
- [5] R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**. 2026 You can't fight in here! This is BBS! *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*. 49:e224. [authorresponse to commentors]
- [6] M. Ryskina, M. R. Gormley, **K. Mahowald**, D. R. Mortensen, T. Berg-Kirkpatrick, V. Kulkarni. 2026. From sunblock to softblock: Analyzing the correlates of neology in published writing and on social media. In Proceedings of the 6th International Workshop on Computational Approaches to Language Change (LChange'26). Rabat, Morocco.
- [7] S. Rakshit, J. Hu, **K. Mahowald**, A. E. Goldberg. 2026. A suite of LMs comprehend puzzle statements as well or better than humans. *Open Mind*, 10, 431–440.
- [8] M. Ramscar, S. Chen, R. Futrell, K. Mahowald. 2026. Cross-Cultural Structures Of Personal Name Systems Reflect General Communicative Principles. *Nature Communications*.
- [9] J. Hu, E. Wilcox, S. Song, **K. Mahowald**, R. Levy. 2026. What can string probability tell us about grammaticality? *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics (TACL)*.

- [10] S. Boguraev, C. Potts, **K. Mahowald**. 2025. Causal interventions reveal shared structure across English filler-gap constructions. In Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing. Suzhou, China. **Outstanding Paper Award**.
- [11] F. Fehlaue, **K. Mahowald**, T. Pimentel. 2025. Convergence and divergence of language models under different random seeds. In Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing. Suzhou, China.
- [12] J. Rozner, L. Weissweiler, **K. Mahowald**, C. Shain. 2025. Constructions are revealed in word distributions. In Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing. Suzhou, China. **Senior Area Chair Highlight Award**.
- [13] G. Tuckute, **K. Mahowald**, P. Isola, A. Oliva, E. Gibson, E. Fedorenko. 2025. Intrinsically memorable words have unique associations with their meanings. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 154(8), 2059–2075. **American Psychological Association Editor’s Choice Article**.
- [14] S. Song, J. Hu*, **K. Mahowald***. 2025. Language models fail to introspect about their knowledge of language. In Proceedings of the Second Conference on Language Modeling (COLM). Montreal, Canada.
- [15] Q. Yao, K. Misra, L. Weissweiler, **K. Mahowald**. 2025. Both direct and indirect evidence contribute to dative alternation preferences in language models. In Proceedings of the Second Conference on Language Modeling (COLM). Montreal, Canada.
- [16] W. B. Sheffield, K. Misra, V. Pyatkin, A. Deo, **K. Mahowald**, J.J. Li. 2025. Is it JUST semantics? A case study of discourse particle understanding in LLMs. In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025, pages 21704–21715, Vienna, Austria.
- [17] S. Boguraev, K. Erk, **K. Mahowald**, J. W. Shearer, S. M. Wechsler. 2025. Reinforcement learning produces efficient case-marking systems. In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Volume 47 (2025), pages 2584-2590.
- [18] J. Ranganathan, R. Jha, K. Misra, **K. Mahowald**. 2025. Semantic-features: A user-friendly tool for studying contextual word embeddings in interpretable semantic spaces. In Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL) 8(1): 44.
- [19] Z. Sprague, Y. Fangcong, J.D. Rodriguez, D. Jiang, M. Wadhwa, P. Singhal, X. Zhao, X. Ye, **K. Mahowald**, G. Durrett. 2025. To CoT or not to CoT? Chain-of-thought helps mainly on math and symbolic reasoning. In Proceedings of the Thirteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2025.

- [20] L. Weissweiler, **K. Mahowald**, A. Goldberg. 2025; In Press. The Second International Workshop on Construction Grammars and NLP.
- [21] S. Padmanabhan, K. Misra, **K. Mahowald**, E. Choi. Accepted; Accepted on July 29, 2025; Final version due September 21, 2025. On language models’ sensitivity to suspicious coincidences. COLM 2025 Workshop PragLM.
- [22] J. Hu, **K. Mahowald**, G. Lupyan, A. Ivanova, R. Levy. 2024. Language models align with human judgments on key grammatical constructions. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 121(36), e2400917121. [letter]
- [23] H. Lederman, **K. Mahowald**. 2024. Are language models more like libraries or like librarians? Bibliotechnism, the novel reference problem, and the attitudes of LLMs. *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 12, 1087-1103.
- [24] ***K. Mahowald**, *A. Ivanova, I. Blank, N. Kanwisher, J. Tenenbaum, E. Fedorenko. 2024. Dissociating language and thought in Large Language Models. *Trends in Cognitive Science*, 28(6), 517-540.
- [25] S. Malik-Moraleda, O. Jouravlev, M. Taliaferro, Z. Mineroff, T. Cucu, **K. Mahowald**, I. Blank, E. Fedorenko. 2024. Functional characterization of the language network of polyglots and hyperpolyglots with precision fMRI. *Cerebral Cortex*, 34(3).
- [26] T. Regev, H.S. Kim, X. Chen, J. Affourtit, A. Schipper, L. Bergen, L., **K. Mahowald**, E. Fedorenko. 2024. High-level language brain regions process sublexical regularities. *Cerebral Cortex*, 34(3).
- [27] S. Boguraev, B. Lipkin, L. Weissweiler, **K. Mahowald**. 2024. Models can and should embrace the communicative nature of human-generated math. The 4th Workshop on Mathematical Reasoning and AI at NeurIPS'24. Vancouver, Canada.
- [28] K. Misra, **K. Mahowald**. 2024. Language models learn rare phenomena from less rare phenomena: the case of the missing AANNs. In Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, pages 913–929, Miami, Florida, USA. **Outstanding Paper Award**.
- [29] V. Govindarajan, M. Zang, **K. Mahowald**, D. Beaver, J. Li. 2024. Do *they* mean ‘us’? Interpreting referring expression variation under intergroup bias. In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2024, pages 9772–9785, Miami, Florida, USA.
- [30] K. Misra, A. Ettinger, **K. Mahowald**. 2024. Experimental contexts can facilitate robust semantic property inference in language models, but inconsistently. In Proceedings of the

2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, pages 12342–12355, Miami, Florida, USA.

- [31] J. Kallini, I. Papadimitriou, R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**, C. Potts. 2024. Mission: impossible language models. In Proceedings of the 62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers), pages 14691–14714, Bangkok, Thailand. **Best Paper Award**.
- [32] K. Denlinger, S. Wechsler, **K. Mahowald**. 2024. Participle-prepended nominals have lower entropy than nominals appended after the participle. In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Volume 46 (2024), pages 594-600.
- [33] T. Pimentel, C. Meister, E. G. Wilcox, **K. Mahowald**, R. Cotterell. 2023. Revisiting the optimality of word lengths. In Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, pages 2240–2255, Singapore, December 2023. **Outstanding Paper Award**.
- [34] Y. Wu, W. Sheffield, **K. Mahowald**, J. Li. 2023. Elaborative simplification as implicit questions under discussion. In Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, pages 5525–5537, Singapore, December 2023.
- [35] M. Mersinias, **K. Mahowald**. 2023. For generated text, is NLI-neutral text the best text? In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2023, pages 2596–2602, Singapore, December 2023.
- [36] **K. Mahowald**. 2023. A discerning several thousand judgments: GPT-3 rates the article + adjective + numeral + noun construction. In Proceedings of the 17th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics, pages 265–273, Dubrovnik, Croatia, May 2023.
- [37] G. Chronis, **K. Mahowald**, K. Erk. 2023. A method for studying semantic construal in grammatical constructions with interpretable contextual embedding spaces. In Proceedings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers), pages 242–261, Toronto, Canada, July 2023.
- [38] J. Huang, Z. Wu, **K. Mahowald**, C. Potts. 2023. Inducing character-level structure in subword-based language models with type-level interchange intervention training. In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2023, pages 12163–12180, Toronto, Canada, July 2023.
- [39] V. Govindarajan, **K. Mahowald**, D. Beaver, J. Li. 2023. Counterfactual probing for the influence of affect and specificity on intergroup bias. In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2023, pages 12853–12862, Toronto, Canada, July 2023.

- [40] A. Srinivasan, V.S. Govindarajan, **K. Mahowald**. 2023. Counterfactually probing language identity in multilingual models. In Proceedings of the 3rd Workshop on Multi-lingual Representation Learning (MRL), pages 24–36, Singapore, December 2023.
- [41] V. Govindarajan, J.D. Rodriguez, K. Bostrom, **K. Mahowald**. 2023. Lil-bevo: Explorations of strategies for training language models in more humanlike ways. In Proceedings of the BabyLM Challenge at the 27th Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning, pages 308-316, Singapore, December 2023.
- [42] S. Chen, R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**. 2023. An information-theoretic approach to the typology of spatial demonstratives. *Cognition*, 240, 105505.
- [43] ***K. Mahowald**, *E. Diachek, E. Gibson, E. Fedorenko, R. Futrell. 2023. Grammatical cues to subjecthood are redundant in a majority of simple clauses across languages. *Cognition*, 241, 105543.
- [44] S. Malik-Moraleda, **K. Mahowald**, B.R. Conway, E. Gibson. 2023. Concepts Are Restructured During Language Contact: The Birth of Blue and Other Color Concepts in Tsimane’-Spanish Bilinguals. *Psychological Science*. 34(12), 1350-1362.
- [45] V. Kovatchev, T. Chatterjee, V. Govindarajan, J. Chen, E. Choi, G. Chronis, A. Das, K. Erk, M. Lease, J. Li, Y. Wu, **K. Mahowald**. 2022. longhorns at DADC 2022: How many linguists does it take to fool a question answering model? a systematic approach to adversarial attacks. In Proceedings of the First Workshop on Dynamic Adversarial Data Collection, pages 41–52, Seattle, Washington, July 2022.
- [46] A. Diwan, L. Berry, E. Choi, D. Harwath, **K. Mahowald**. 2022. Why is Winoground hard? investigating failures in visuolinguistic compositionality. In Proceedings of the 2022 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, pages 2236–2250, Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates, December 2022.
- [47] A. Kaushal, **K. Mahowald**. 2022. What do tokens know about their characters and how do they know it? In Proceedings of the 2022 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies, pages 2487–2507, Seattle, United States, July 2022.
- [48] I. Papadimitriou, R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**. 2022. When classifying grammatical role, BERT doesn’t care about word order... except when it matters. In Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 2: Short Papers), pages 636–643, Dublin, Ireland, May 2022.
- [49] N. Rezaii, **K. Mahowald**, R. Ryskin, B. Dickerson, E. Gibson. 2022. A syntax–lexicon trade-off in language production. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 119 (25), e2120203119.

- [50] J. Rozner, C. Potts, **K. Mahowald**. 2021. Decrypting cryptic crosswords: semantically complex wordplay puzzles as a target for NLP. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 34: Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems 2021*, pages 11409–11421, Online, December 2021.
- [51] A. Jones, W. Wang, **K. Mahowald**. 2021. A massively multilingual analysis of cross-linguality in shared embedding space. In *Proceedings of the 2021 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pages 5833–5847, Online and Punta Cana, Dominican Republic, November 2021.
- [52] T. Pimentel, I. Nikkarinen, **K. Mahowald**, R. Cotterell, D. Blasi. 2021. How (non-)optimal is the lexicon? In *Proceedings of the 2021 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies*, pages 4426–4438, Online, June 2021.
- [53] I. Papadimitriou, R. Futrell, E. Chi, **K. Mahowald**. 2021. Deep subjecthood: Higher-order grammatical features in multilingual BERT. In *Proceedings of the 16th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Main Volume*, pages 2522–2532, Online, April 2021.
- [54] **K. Mahowald**, D. Jurafsky, M. Norris. 2021. Concord begets concord: A Bayesian model of nominal concord typology. In *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America*, 6(1):541–555, 2021.
- [55] B. Schmidt, S.T. Piantadosi, **K. Mahowald**. 2021. Uncontrolled corpus composition drives an apparent surge in cognitive distortions. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 118(45), e2115010118. [letter]
- [56] D. Card, P. Henderson, U. Khandelwal, R. Jia, **K. Mahowald**, D. Jurafsky. 2020. With little power comes great responsibility. In *Proceedings of the 2020 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pages 9263–9274, Online, November 2020.
- [57] **K. Mahowald**, G. Kachergis, M.C. Frank. 2020. What counts as an exemplar model, anyway? A commentary on Ambridge (2020). *First Language*, 40(5-6), 608-611.
- [58] E. Gibson, R. Futrell, S.T. Piantadosi, I. Dautriche, **K. Mahowald**, L. Bergen, R. Levy. 2019. How efficiency shapes human language. *Trends in Cognitive Science*, 23(5), 389-407.
- [59] **K. Mahowald**, I. Dautriche, E. Gibson, S.T. Piantadosi. 2018. Word forms are structured for efficient use. *Cognitive Science*, 42(8), 3116-3134.

- [60] Z. Mineroff, I.A. Blank, **K. Mahowald**, E. Fedorenko. 2018. A robust dissociation among the language, multiple demand, and default mode networks: evidence from inter-region correlations in effect size. *Neuropsychologia*, 119, 501-511.
- [61] *I. Dautriche, ***K. Mahowald**, E. Gibson, A. Christophe, S.T. Piantadosi. 2017. Words cluster phonetically beyond phonotactic regularities. *Cognition*, 163, 128-145.
- [62] E. Gibson, C. Tan, R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**, L. Konieczny, B. Hemforth, E. Fedorenko. 2017. Don't underestimate the benefits of being misunderstood. *Psychological Science*, 28(6), 703-712.
- [63] E. Gibson, R. Futrell, J. Jara-Ettinger, **K. Mahowald**, L. Bergen, S. Ratnasingam, M. Gibson, S.T. Piantadosi, B.R. Conway. 2017. Color naming across languages reflects color use. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 114(40), 10785-10790.
- [64] **K. Mahowald**, A. James, R. Futrell, E. Gibson. 2017. Structural priming is most useful when the conclusions are statistically robust. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 40, page 35. [commentary on target article]
- [65] I. Dautriche, **K. Mahowald**, E. Gibson, S.T. Piantadosi. 2017. Wordform similarity increases with semantic similarity: an analysis of 100 languages. *Cognitive Science*, 41(8):2149–2169.
- [66] **K. Mahowald**, A. James, R. Futrell, E. Gibson. 2016. A meta-analysis of syntactic priming. *Journal of Memory and Language*, 91, 5-27.
- [67] **K. Mahowald**, E. Fedorenko. 2016. Reliable individual-level neural markers of highlevel language processing: A necessary precursor for relating neural variability to behavioral and genetic variability. *Neuroimage*, 139, 74-93.
- [68] I. Blank, Z. Balewski, **K. Mahowald**, E. Fedorenko. 2016. Syntactic processing is distributed across the language system. *Neuroimage*, 127, 307-323.
- [69] **K. Mahowald**, P. Graff, J. Hartman, E. Gibson. 2016. SNAP Judgments: A Small N Acceptability Paradigm (SNAP) for linguistic acceptability judgments. *Language*, 92 (3), 619-635.
- [70] R. Singh, E. Fedorenko, **K. Mahowald**, E. Gibson. 2016. Accommodating presuppositions is inappropriate in implausible contexts. *Cognitive Science*, 40(3), 607–634.
- [71] R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**, E. Gibson. 2015. Large-scale evidence of dependency length minimization in 37 languages. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. 112 (33), 10336-10341.

- [72] R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**, E. Gibson. 2015. Quantifying word order freedom in dependency corpora. In Proceedings of the Third International Conference on Dependency Linguistics (Depling 2015), pages 91–100, Uppsala, Sweden, August 2015. Uppsala University, Uppsala, Sweden.
- [73] E. Gibson, P. Jacobson, P. Graff, E. Fedorenko, **K. Mahowald**, S.T. Piantadosi. 2015. A pragmatic account of complexity in definite Antecedent-Contained-Deletion relative clauses. *Journal of Semantics*. 32 (4): 579-618.
- [74] **K. Mahowald** and E. Gibson. 2013. Short, frequent words are more likely to appear genetically related by chance. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 110(35), E3253-E3253. [letter]
- [75] **K. Mahowald**, E. Fedorenko, S.T. Piantadosi, E. Gibson. 2013. Info/information theory: speakers choose shorter words in predictive contexts. *Cognition*, 126, 313-318.
- [76] **K. Mahowald**. 2012. A Naive Bayes classifier for Shakespeare’s second person pronoun. *Literary and Linguistic Computing*. 27(1), 17-23.
- [77] **K. Mahowald**. 2011. An LFG approach to word order freezing. In M. Butt and T. H. King, editors, Proceedings of the LFG11 Conference, pages 381-400. Hong Kong, 2011. CSLI Publications.
- [78] **K. Mahowald**. 2010. “It may nat be”: Chaucer, Derrida, and the impossibility of the gift. *Studies in the Age of Chaucer*, 32, 129-150.

Peer-Reviewed Book Chapters

- [79] **K. Mahowald**, I. Dautriche, M. Braginsky, T. Gibson. 2022. Efficient communication and the organization of the lexicon. In Anna Papafragou, John C. Trueswell, and Lila R. Gleitman, editors, *The Oxford Handbook of the Mental Lexicon*, Oxford Handbooks, pages 200-220. Oxford University Press.

Popular Science Articles

- [80] S. AnderBois, **K. Mahowald**, N. Tomlin. 2023. The unspoken language of crosswords. *The Atlantic*.
- [81] **K. Mahowald**, A. Ivanova [authors]. E. Fedorenko, I. Blank, J. Tenenbaum, N. Kanwisher [contributors]. 2022. Google’s powerful AI spotlights a human cognitive glitch: Mistaking fluent speech for fluent thought. *The Conversation*.

Tutorials

- R. Cotterell, R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**, C. Meister, T. Pimentel, A. Williams, A. Arora. 2022. Information theory in linguistics: methods and applications. COLING 2022.

Media Appearances and Interviews

Articles With Kyle Mahowald Research Featured and/or Quotes from Kyle Mahowald

- *Quanta*, “Can AI Models Show Us How People Learn? Impossible Languages Point a Way.”, January 2025
- *Communications of the ACM (Association for Computing Machinery)*, “Conversations with AI: The promises and pitfalls of LLMs for the study of languages”, March 2024
- *TechTalks*, “To understand language models, we must separate language from thought”, February 2023
- *Wired*, “Some Glimpse AGI in ChatGPT. Others Call It a Mirage”, January 2023
- *The Atlantic*, “The Difference Between Speaking and Thinking”, January 2023
-

Kyle Mahowald Quoted as Expert

- Guest on NPR’s “On Point”, “Brainwaves: Is AI actually thinking?”, February 2026
- *The Economist*’s Babbage Podcast, “Babbage: The science that built the AI revolution—part four”, March 2024

Kyle Mahowald Quoted as Expert

- *The New York Times*, “Do We Need Language to Think?”, June 2024
- *Fort Worth Star Telegram*, “How do you say Bexar, Boerne or Gruene? Why some Texas places are impossible to pronounce”, August 2023
- *Life & Letters Magazine*, “On the Beauty of Crosswords”, July 2023
- *The Ringer*, “What to Do When Playing the Word Game Wordle Isn’t Enough? Solve It.”, January 2022
- *Stanford Daily*, “How to beat Wordle: linguists from Stanford explain”, February 2022
- *Fort Worth Star Telegram*, “Wordle strategy: Common daily words to start the online game”, March 2022
- *Slate*, “Rohds. Rowds. Row-ads? Rhowds???” , March 2015
- *Seattle Times*, “Sudoku as spectator sport: Game has its first smackdown”, March 2006

Media Panels

- SouthBySouthwest (SXSW) Panel Organizer and Panelist (with Robbie Kubala, Adrienne Raphel, Natan Last), “The Art of Crosswords”, March 2024

Panels at UT

- Making AI Human (with Harvey Lederman), Alumni Zoom Discussion hosted by Dan Oppenheimer

SCHOLARLY PRESENTATIONS

Invited Scholarly Talks at External Institutions

- **K. Mahowald.** July 2026. How Linguistics Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Language Models. Keynote, International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2). Burlington, Vermont.
- **K. Mahowald.** July 2026. Linguistic Interpretability and Linguistic Efficiency. Invited Symposium at CogSci 2026 on Language (In)efficiency. Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.
- **K. Mahowald.** May 2026. How Linguistics Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Language Models. Communications & Intelligence. Toyota Technological Institute at Chicago and University of Chicago. Chicago, Illinois. [virtual]
- **K. Mahowald.** May 2026. How We Learn Language. Austin Salon. Austin, Texas.
- **K. Mahowald.** April 2026. Panel on LLMs and Linguistics (with Ellie Pavlick, David Pesetsky, Danny Fox; moderated by Roman Feiman). Brown University. Providence, Rhode Island.
- **K. Mahowald.** March 2026. Institute of Cognitive Science Colloquium. University of Colorado Boulder. Boulder, Colorado.
- **K. Mahowald.** March 2026. Schwartz-Reisman Institute Seminar Series. University of Toronto. Toronto, Canada. [virtual]
- **K. Mahowald.** March 2026. Measuring AI Introspection. Workshop on Metacognition, Inner Speech, and Artificial Intelligence. University of Florida. Gainesville, Florida.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2026. Invited Symposium: Linguistics in the Age of Language Models. American Philosophical Association 2026 Central Division Meeting.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2026. Linguistics Colloquium. University of California, San Diego. San Diego, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** December 2025. Invited Participant and Speaker at Science of Stories: Santa Fe Working Group. Santa Fe Institute. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
- **K. Mahowald.** October 2025. Cognitive Science Colloquium. Indiana University. Bloomington, Indiana.
- **K. Mahowald.** October 2025. Keynote at First Workshop on the Interplay of Model Behavior and Model Internals at COLM 2025. Montreal, Canada.
- **K. Mahowald.** September 2025. Keynote at LLMs and the Brain Workshop. Rice University. Houston, Texas.

- **K. Mahowald.** July 2025. Invited Participant at Dagstuhl Seminar 25301: Linguistics and Language Models: What Can They Learn from Each Other? Wadern, Germany.
- **K. Mahowald.** July 2025. Linguistic Insights from Language Models. Edinburgh University Informatics Department Colloquium. Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
- **K. Mahowald.** July 2025. Linguistic Insights from Language Models. Saarland University Language Science Colloquium. Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany.
- **K. Mahowald.** May 2025. Statistics and Abstraction in Today's Models: an Overview. Invited Panelist and Speaker for Statistics and Abstraction in Today's Computational Models. 2025 Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention. Washington, D.C.
- **K. Mahowald.** April 2025. Psycholinguistic Insights from Small Language Models. Colloquium for University of California, Irvine, Center for Theoretical Behavioral Sciences. Irvine, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** April 2025. Psycholinguistic Insights from Small Language Models. Online Symposium for the Society for Human Sentence Processing. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** March 2025. Measuring Language and Thought in Large Language Models. Invited Participant and Speaker. Santa Fe Institute Workshop on Measuring AI. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2025. How Linguistics Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Language Models. Simons Institute Workshop: LLMs, Cognitive Science, Linguistics, and Neuroscience. Berkeley, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** January 2025. Language Models as Glass Boxes Invited Panelist and Speaker on "Large language models, linguistics, and psycholinguistics." 2025 Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting. Philadelphia, Pennsylvania.
- **K. Mahowald.** December 2024. Finding Linguistic Insight in Large Language Models. Princeton University Department of Linguistics. Princeton, New Jersey.
- **K. Mahowald.** November 2024. On Language Models, Bibliotechnism, and Real Patterns. Philosophy of Computing Conference. Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México (UNAM), Mexico City, Mexico. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** November 2024. Language Models as Linguistic Glass Boxes. Department of Linguistics Colloquium. Georgetown University. Washington, D.C.
- **K. Mahowald.** October 2024. Language Models as Linguistic Glass Boxes. Invited Speaker and Participant. Workshop on LLMs and Linguistics in Honor of Annie Zaenen. Konstanz, Germany.
- **K. Mahowald.** June 2024. Learning About Language Models from a Lovely Three Weeks in Antwerp. CLiPS (Computational Linguistics, Psycholinguistics and Sociolinguistics) Colloquium. University of Antwerp, Antwerp, Belgium.
- **K. Mahowald.** June 2024. Studying How Language Models Produce Text by Studying What They are Trained On. Invited Speaker and Participant. National Science

Foundation-Funded Workshop: Text Production and Comprehension by Human and Artificial Intelligence. Virtual.

- **K. Mahowald.** June 2024. ANNs and AANNs: Linguistic Insights from Language Models. Using Artificial Neural Networks for Studying Human Language Learning and Processing. Amsterdam, Netherlands.
- **K. Mahowald.** June 2024 .Using Language Models for Linguistics. Invited Speaker and Panelist. Université du Québec à Montréal Summer School: Understanding LLM Understanding. Montreal, Canada. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** May 2024. Linguistic Insights from LLMs. Evolutionary Linguistics Group, Department of Linguistics, Edinburgh University. Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
- **K. Mahowald.** May 2024. Learning About Language Models from a Lovely Rainy Five Days in Edinburgh. Department of Linguistics, Edinburgh University. Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
- **K. Mahowald.** May 2024. Comments on Language Models and Linguistics. Invited Commenter and Participant. National Science Foundation Workshop on Large Language Models, National Science Foundation Headquarters, Alexandria, Virginia.
- **K. Mahowald.** April 2024. Learning About Language Models from a Lovely Two Days in Providence. LingLangLunch Talk Series. Brown University, Providence, Rhode Island.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2024. Invited Speaker and Panelist. American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS) Meeting Symposium on panel The Promises and Pitfalls of Large Language Models for Science and Society. Denver, Colorado.
- **K. Mahowald.** November 2023. Formal and Functional Competence in Large Language Models. Keynote Speaker. Formae Mentis Conference. Pisa University, Pisa, Italy.
- **K. Mahowald.** September 2023. Formal and Functional Competence in Large Language Models. Virtual Psycholinguistics Forum (VPF) in Hong Kong. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** June 2023. Formal and Functional Competence in Large Language Models. Santa Fe Institute, Santa Fe, New Mexico.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2023. Dissociating Language and Thought in Large Language Models. Online Philosophy of Deep Learning Group. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** March 2023. Formal and Functional Competence in Large Language Models. Allen Institute for AI Mosaic Group. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald** (with A. Ivanova). March 2023. Formal and Functional Competence in Large Language Models. Intel Corporation Deep Learning Community of Practice. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald** (with A. Ivanova). March 2023. Formal and Functional Competence in Large Language Models. NERT (Nathan's Excellent Research Team) Group Meeting in Georgetown Linguistics. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald** (with A. Ivanova). April 2023. Formal and Functional Competence in Large Language Models. Kuis AI Talk. Koç University, Istanbul, Turkey. Virtual.

- **K. Mahowald.** April 2023. Exploring an Interesting Few Constructions in Large Language Models. UC Irvine Language Sciences Department Colloquium, UC Irvine, Irvine, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** December 2022. A Hopefully Interesting Few Studies on Constructions in Large Language Models. Princeton Language Group. Princeton University, Princeton, New Jersey.
- **K. Mahowald.** June 2022. Exploring Subjectivity in Large Language Models. Subjectivity and Semantic Interpretation Workshop at The North American Summer School for Logic, Language and Information (NASSLLI) 2022. Los Angeles, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** September 2021. Deep Subjecthood. ACL Special Interest Group on Typology (SIGTYP) Online Lecture Series. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** March 2021. Exploring Grammatical Role in Large Language Models. Linguistics Department. Boston University. Boston, Massachusetts. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** March 2021. Deep Subjecthood: Exploring Grammatical Role in Humans and Machines. Linguistics Department. The University of Texas at Austin, Austin, Texas. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** August 2020. A BERT's Eye View of Linguistics. Trace [machine learning company]. Modesto, California. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** June 2020. Understanding Linguistic Structure through Computational Models of Language. Linguistics Department. University of California, Santa Cruz. Santa Cruz, California. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** April 2020. Computation and Language. Apple, Inc. Cupertino, California. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2020. Computational and Communicative Pressures in Language. Linguistics Department, Boston University. Boston, Massachusetts.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2020. Cognitive Pressures in Language. Linguistics Department, The University of Texas at Austin. Austin, Texas.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2020. Cognitive and Communicative Pressures in Language. Department of Psychology, Department of Language Sciences. University of Wisconsin Madison. Madison, Wisconsin.
- **K. Mahowald.** January 2020. Human Language as a Window into Cognition. Department of Psychology. University of California Berkeley. Berkeley, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** January 2020. Communicative Pressures in Language. Linguistics Department. University of California Santa Barbara. Santa Barbara, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** March 2019. Cognitive and Communicative Pressures in Natural Language. Department of Linguistics and Department of Computer Science. McGill University. Montreal, Canada.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2019. Cognitive and Communicative Pressures in Language. School of Philosophy, Psychology, and Language Sciences. Edinburgh University. Edinburgh, United Kingdom.

- **K. Mahowald.** February 2019. Cognitive and Communicative Pressures in Language. Department of Linguistics. University of Florida. Gainesville, Florida.
- **K. Mahowald.** January 2019. Cognitive and Communicative Pressures in Language. Department of Linguistics. Northwestern University. Evanston, Illinois.
- **K. Mahowald.** December 2014. Efficient Structure in the Lexicon. Mini-Symposium on the Neural and Cognitive Mechanisms of Language. Department of Psychology. Harvard University. Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- **K. Mahowald.** October 2014. Efficient Lexical Structure. Department of Brain and Cognitive Sciences. University of Rochester. Rochester, New York.
- **K. Mahowald.** May 2014. Learning and Organizational Structure of the Lexicon. Stanford Language and Cognition Lab Meeting. Stanford University. Stanford, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** October 2010. Verb Clusters in Old English. 3rd South of England Lexical-Functional Grammar Meeting. SOAS University of London. London, United Kingdom.

Invited Scholarly Talks at Home Institutions or Past Home Institutions

- **K. Mahowald.** November 2025. How Linguistics Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Language Models. Undergrad Linguistic Society Meeting.
- **K. Mahowald** and H. Lederman. October 2024. Organizer and Invited Speaker at Language, Mind, and Ethics in AI. Workshop at The University of Texas at Austin. Austin, Texas.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2024. Linguistic Insights from Language Models. Keynote Speaker for Texas Linguistic Society, UT Austin. Austin, Texas.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2022. Redundancy of Grammatical Cues and Word Meanings. Ev Fedorenko Lab Meeting. MIT. Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- **K. Mahowald.** January 2021. Language models: Surprisingly Good at Modeling Language, Unsurprisingly Bad at Modeling Thought. UT Linguistics Syntax-Semantics Research Seminar. Austin, Texas.
- **K. Mahowald.** January 2020. Cognitive and Communicative Pressures in Language. Language and Cognition Talk Series. Stanford University. Stanford, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** October 2019. NLP, Communication, and Language. NLP Lunch. Stanford University. Stanford, California.
- **K. Mahowald.** May 2015. Four Mini-Talks in Psycholinguistics. CogLunch. Department of Brain and Cognitive Sciences. MIT. Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- **K. Mahowald.** April 2013. Finding Structure in the Lexicon. CogLunch. MIT. Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- **K. Mahowald.** April 2013. Efficient Lexical Design. Tedlab Lab Meeting. MIT. Cambridge, Massachusetts.

- **K. Mahowald.** October 2011. Computationally Classifying the Second Person Pronoun in Early Modern English. Tedlab Lab Meeting. MIT. Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- **K. Mahowald.** February 2011. Word Order Freezing in Old English. Oxford Syntax Working Group. Oxford, United Kingdom.

Peer-Reviewed Conference and Workshop Presentations/Posters (Abstracts Only)

- S. Boguraev, C. Potts, **K. Mahowald.** 2025. Causal interventions reveal shared structure across English filler-gap constructions. First Workshop on the Interplay of Model Behavior and Model Internals: A Workshop at the Conference for Language Modeling (COLM) 2025. Montreal, Canada.
- S. Malik-Moraleda, **K. Mahowald**, B. Conway, E. Gibson. 2022. Frequency trumps proficiency during lexical access: Color naming in Tsimane’–Spanish bilinguals. Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) Conference. York, United Kingdom.
- S. Chen, R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald.** 2022. Investigating information-theoretic properties of the typology of spatial demonstratives. ACL Special Interest Group on Typology (SIGTYP) Workshop. Seattle, Washington.
- S. Chen, R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald.** 2022. An information-theoretic approach to the typology of spatial demonstratives. Human Sentence Processing (HSP) Conference. Virtual.
- I. Papadimitriou, R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald.** 2022. When classifying arguments, BERT doesn’t care about word order... except when it matters. Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL) Annual Meeting. Virtual.
- T. Cucu & **K. Mahowald.** 2021. How do linguistics papers talk about non-English languages? Presented at Metascience 2021. Virtual.
- **K. Mahowald**, I. Papadimitriou, D. Jurafsky, R. Futrell. 2021. Accessibility-based constraints on morphosyntax in corpora of 54 languages. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Virtual.
- M. Yen, I. Blank, **K. Mahowald.** 2021. Competing effects of syntax and animacy in priming of relative clause attachment. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Virtual.
- N. Rezaei, **K. Mahowald**, R. Ryskin, B. Dickerson, E. Gibson. 2021. Syntactic rule frequency as a measure of syntactic complexity: Insights from primary progressive aphasia. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Virtual.
- I. Papadimitriou, R. Futrell, E. Chi, **K. Mahowald.** 2021. Multilingual BERT, ergativity, and grammatical subjecthood. Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL) Annual Meeting. Virtual.
- I. Papadimitriou, R. Futrell, E. Chi, **K. Mahowald.** 2020. Multilingual BERT learns abstract case representations. ACL Special Interest Group on Typology (SIGTYP) Workshop. Virtual.

- T. I. Regev, J. Affourtit, X. Chen, L. Bergen, **K. Mahowald**, E. Fedorenko. 2020. Sensitivity of high-level language processing brain regions to phonological information. Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL) Conference. Virtual.
- S. Ratnasingam, E. Gibson, R. Futrell, J. Jara-Ettinger, **K. Mahowald**, L. Bergen, S. T. Piantadosi, B. Conway. 2017. Statistical variations in the power spectrum of daylight over a day predict communicative efficiency of color-language. Vision Sciences Society (VSS) Annual Meeting. St. Pete Beach, Florida.
- **K. Mahowald**, A. James, R. Futrell, E. Gibson. 2016. A meta-analysis of syntactic priming in language production. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Gainesville, Florida.
- **K. Mahowald**, M. Kline, E. Fedorenko, E. Gibson. 2015. Informativity and efficient compression of sentences. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing.
- **K. Mahowald**, S. T. Piantadosi, M. Alper, E. Gibson. 2015. Lexical items are privileged slots for meaning. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Los Angeles, California.
- **K. Mahowald**, I. Dautriche, E. Gibson, A. Christophe, S.T. Piantadosi. 2014. Efficient phonological clustering in the mental lexicon. International Conference on the Mental Lexicon. Niagara-on-the-Lake, Ontario, Canada.
- I. Dautriche, **K. Mahowald**, E. Gibson, A. Christophe, S.T. Piantadosi. 2014. Lexical clustering in efficient language design. Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) Conference. Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
- **K. Mahowald**, P. Graff, J. Hartman, E. Gibson. 2014. SNAP judgments: Small N Acceptability Paradigm (SNAP) for linguistic judgments. Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) Conference. Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
- R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**, E. Gibson. 2014. CLIQS: Cross-linguistic investigations in quantitative syntax. Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) Conference. Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
- **K. Mahowald**, P. Isola, E. Fedorenko, A. Oliva, E. Gibson. 2014. An information-theoretic account of word memorability. Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) Conference. Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
- **K. Mahowald** & E. Fedorenko. 2014. Reliable individual-level neural markers of language activity. Neurobiology of Language Conference. Amsterdam, Netherlands.
- E. Gibson, P. Jacobson, P. Graff, **K. Mahowald**, E. Fedorenko, S. T. Piantadosi. 2014. Pragmatic influences on the processing of ACD relative clauses. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Columbus, Ohio.
- R. Futrell, **K. Mahowald**, S. T. Piantadosi, E. Gibson. 2014. Efficient communication forwards and backwards. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Columbus, Ohio.
- **K. Mahowald**, S. T. Piantadosi, E. Gibson. 2013. Lexical clustering in efficient language design. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Columbia, South Carolina.

- **K. Mahowald**, A. Jacobs, A. Fahimipour, M. Kleiman-Weiner. 2013. Measure for measure: Quantifying Shakespearean drama. Links Conference, MIT Media Lab. Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- **K. Mahowald**, T. J. O'Donnell, J. B. Tenenbaum. 2013. Filling in the blanks in morphological productivity: A word completion task. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Columbia, South Carolina.
- **K. Mahowald**, E. Fedorenko, S. T. Piantadosi, E. Gibson. 2012. Speakers actively choose shorter words in predictive contexts. CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. New York, New York.

RESEARCH FUNDING

Sponsored Research Funding -- Candidate Serves as PI/ co-PI/ co-I

Current:

National Science Foundation	2024-2029
PI: K. Mahowald (UT Austin) . "CAREER: Investigating Linguistic and Cognitive Abstractions for Solving Word Problems in Minds and Machines."	
Relative contributions to project: Mahowald (100%)	
Candidate funding: \$1,386,988	
Role of the Candidate: PI	
Total funding to UT: \$1,386,988	
National Science Foundation	2025-2028
PI: K. Mahowald (UT Austin) . "Collaborative Research: Social, Behavioral, and Economic Sciences (SBE)-UKRI (UK Research and Innovation): Spatial Communication and Computational Efficiency."	
Relative contributions to project among UT PIs: Mahowald (100%)	
Candidate funding: \$197,887	
Role of the Candidate: PI	
Total funding to UT: \$197,887	
<i>University of California Irvine PI: R. Futrell. University of East Anglia PI: K. Coventry.</i>	
<i>Total project award (UT Austin, University of California Irvine, University of East Anglia): \$1,344,690 (estimated since UK award is in GBP)</i>	
Good Ventures Foundation, via Open Philanthropy	2024-2027
PI: C. Tarsney (UT Austin) until August 2025; K. Mahowald (UT Austin) after August 2025. "AI Safety Research & Field-Building Project."	

Relative contributions to project among UT PIs: K. Mahowald (~8%)
Co-PIs: B. Knox until August 2025; H. Lederman and B. Knox after August 2025.
Faculty: S. Aaronson, M. Budolfson, J. Dever, K. Kuruc, H. Lederman [Co-PI after August 2025], M. Lee, J. Li, L. Liu, K. Mahowald [PI after August 2025], P. Stone, S. Strover
Candidate funding: ~\$57,000
Role of the Candidate: Faculty until August 2025; PI after August 2025
Total funding to UT: \$775,000

National Science Foundation 2023-2027

PI: M. Gligoric (UT Austin). “Collaborative Research: SHF: Medium: Natural Language Models with Execution Data for Software Testing.”

Co-PI: **K. Mahowald**, J. Li

Relative contributions to project among UT PIs: Gligoric (33.3%), Mahowald (33.3%), Li (33.3%);

Candidate funding: \$300,000

Role of the Candidate: Co-PI

Total funding to UT: \$900,000

National Science Foundation collaborative project; collaboration institution: University of Illinois at Urbana Champaign, PI: S. Misailovic. Total project award: \$1,200,000

Completed:

National Science Foundation 2021-2024

PI: **K. Mahowald (UT Austin)**. “Computer and Information Science and Engineering (CISE) Research Initiation Initiative (CRII): Robust Intelligence (RI): Using Linguistic Variation to Understand Deep Neural Models.”

Relative contributions to project: Mahowald (100%)

Candidate funding: \$175,000

Role of the Candidate: PI

Total funding to UT: \$175,000

National Science Foundation 2015-2016

PI: E. Gibson (MIT). “Doctoral Dissertation Research: Investigating Cognitive and Communicative Pressures on Natural Language Lexicons”

Co-PI: **K. Mahowald (MIT)**

Relative contributions to project: Mahowald (100%)

Candidate funding: \$11,984 (Y1: \$11,984)

Role of the Candidate: Co-PI

Total funding to MIT: \$11,984

[Completed while grad student at MIT so does not appear on External Grants Report]

Internal Research Funding -Candidate Serves as PI/ co-PI/ co-I at UT Austin

Completed:

UT Austin Office of Vice President of Research Bold Inquiry Incubator 2024-2025
Personnel: **K. Mahowald (UT Austin)**, Harvey Lederman (UT Austin), Mark Budolfson (UT Austin). “Language, Mind, and Ethics in AI”
Total funding: \$20,000 seed funding for workshop and research in AI and AI ethics

UT Austin Signature Course Funding Spring 2025
Personnel: **K. Mahowald (UT Austin)**, Robbie Kubala (UT Austin)
Total funding: \$1,000 for student class research projects

UT Austin Signature Course Funding Spring 2023
Personnel: **K. Mahowald (UT Austin)**, Robbie Kubala (UT Austin)
Total funding: \$1,000 for student class research projects “UGS 303 Ethics of Artificial Intelligence: Data & Language 2023”

UT Austin Academic Enrichment Fund for Travel to UK Fall 2021
Personnel: **K. Mahowald (UT Austin)**
Total funding: \$4,000 to visit University of Edinburgh Linguistics

Internal Research Funding -Candidate Serves as PI/ co-PI/ co-I at UCSB [Completed while at UCSB, so do not appear on External Grants Report]

Completed:

UC Santa Barbara Senate Faculty Grant [declined] Spring 2021
Personnel: **K. Mahowald (UC Santa Barbara)**
Total funding: \$15,000 for computational linguistics research [declined due to move to UT Austin before funds were used]

UC Santa Barbara Interdisciplinary Humanities Collaborations in the 2020 Virtual Classroom Grant Spring 2021
Personnel: **K. Mahowald (UC Santa Barbara)**, Robbie Kubala (UC Santa Cruz)
Total funding: \$1,100 for virtual teaching activity

Gifts and Other External Research Awards or Contracts

Completed:

UT Austin College of Liberal Arts Discretionary Fund

Spring 2024

Personnel: **K. Mahowald (UT Austin)**, Robbie Kubala (UC Santa Cruz)

Total funding: \$2,000 for bringing external panelists to “Art of Crosswords” panel at SouthBySouthwest 2024

MENTORING ACTIVITIES

Postdoctoral Fellow Mentored

- William Rudman (50%), Computer Science and Linguistics, 2025-
- Leonie Weissweiler, Linguistics, 2024-2025
 - First placement: Postdoc, Uppsala University
- Kaniskha Misra, Linguistics, 2023-2024
 - First placement: Research Assistant Professor, Toyota Technological Institute at Chicago
- Liam Blything, Visiting Postdoc from Liverpool University (6 weeks), Linguistics, 2023

Primary Graduate Student Advisor

- Qing Yao, UT Austin Linguistics, 2024-present
- Sasha Boguraev, UT Austin Linguistics, 2024-present

First Year Paper Reader

- Qing Yao, UT Austin Linguistics, 2024-2025
- Sasha Boguraev, UT Austin Linguistics, 2024-2025
- Sooji Lee, UT Austin Linguistics, 2023-2024
- William Sheffield, UT Austin Linguistics, 2022-2023

Second Year Paper Reader

- Sooji Lee, UT Austin Linguistics, 2024-2025

Prospectus Committee

- William Sheffield, UT Austin Linguistics, 2024-2025

Non-Area First Year Advisor

- Ethan Hartzell, UT Austin Linguistics, 2023-2024

Ph.D. Dissertation Committees

- Thomas Hikaru Clark, MIT Brain and Cognitive Sciences, Ongoing (Member)
- Hongli Zhan, UT Linguistics, Ongoing (Member)
- Gabriella Chronis, UT Austin Linguistics, Ongoing (Member)
- Yejin Cho, UT Austin Linguistics, Ongoing (Member)
- Agnese Lombardi, University of Pisa Linguistics, 2026 (Reader)
- Ben Lipkin, MIT Brain and Cognitive Sciences, 2025 (Member)
- Nafal Hostens, UT Austin German, 2025 (Member)
- Venkata Govindarajan, UT Austin Linguistics, 2024 (Member)
 - First placement: Assistant Professor of Computer Science, Ithaca College
- Kristin Denlinger, UT Austin Linguistics, 2024 (Member)
 - First placement: Lecturer in Linguistics, UT Austin
- Isabel Papadimitriou, Stanford Linguistics, 2024 (Member)
 - First placement: Assistant Professor of Linguistics, University of British Columbia (deferred for Harvard Kempner postdoc)
- Phill Rogers, UCSB, 2022 (Member)
 - First placement: Visiting Teaching Assistant Professor, University of Pittsburgh

UT Computer Science Research Preparation Exam External Member

- Nathaniel Sauerberg, UT Austin Computer Science, 2024

Master's Thesis Committees

- Michail Mersinias, UT Austin Computer Science, 2023 (Chair)
- Anirudh Srinivasan, UT Austin Computer Science, 2023 (Member)
- Gabriella Chronis, UT Austin Linguistics, 2022 (Member)
- Jaylen Pittman, UCSB, 2021 (Member)

Independent Master's Projects Supervised

- Ayush Kaushal, UT Austin Computer Science, 2021-2022.

Undergraduate Research Supervision

- Siyuan Song, UT Austin, 2024-
- Jwalanthi Ranganathan, UT Austin, 2023-2025
- Ishan Shah, UT Austin, 2022-2023
- Reese Feldmeier, UT Austin, 2022-2023
- Isabel Erwin, UT Austin, 2022-2023
- Emma Gueorguieva, UT Austin, 2022-2023
- Kathryn Kazanas, UT Austin, 2022-2023
- Keziah Reina, UT Austin, 2022-2023
- Lindia Tjuatja, UT Austin, 2021-2022

- Alex Jones, Dartmouth College, 2020-2021

ADMINISTRATIVE AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Service to Linguistics

- Chair, Faculty Search Committee for Computational Linguistics, 2025-2026
- Faculty Advisor, Texas Linguistic Society, 2024-present
- Member, Colloquium Committee, 2021-2026; Chair 2022-2023 and 2025-2026
- Member, Faculty Search Committee for Computational Linguistics, 2024-2025
- Participant, Ad-hoc meetings to form Computer Science + Linguistics major, 2024-2025
- Member, Curriculum Committee, 2022-2024
- Member, Executive Committee, 2022-2023
- Member, Committee to Nominate Dallas TACA Professor [endowed professorship], 2022

Service to College of Liberal Arts

- Member, UT College of Liberal Arts Competitive Scholarship Committee; rank applicants each semester for scholarships; 2021-2024
- Member, UT Data in the Social and Behavioral Sciences Task Force, 2022-2023

Service to UT Austin

- Co-organizer, Ray Mooney's Retirement Festreden, 2026
- Internal Reviewer, 2026 Mellon Foundation Higher Learning Program, 2026
- Member, Scholarships Selection Committee in the Office of Distinguished and Postgraduate Scholarships (for Marshall, Rhodes, and other distinguished fellowships; chair: Douglas Bruster); participant in university's endorsement decisions; interviewer of candidates for endorsement; mentor and mock interviewer for numerous Marshall and Rhodes candidates, 2021-present
- Member, Office of the Vice President of Research University Research Excellence Awards - University Creative Endeavor Award Committee, 2025
- Member, Quantitative Reasoning Flag Committee 2024-2025
- Participant, Signature Course Program Reading Roundup, 2023

Selected Service Before UT Austin

- Committee member, UCSB National Scholarships Selection Committee, 2020-2021

Service to Profession: National Science Foundation Panelist Service

- Ad-hoc panelist, National Science Foundation Linguistics, September 2025
- Ad-hoc panelist, National Science Foundation Education and Human Resources (EHR), October 2021

- Ad-hoc panelist, National Science Foundation Computer and Information Science and Engineering (CISE), April 2021

Service to Profession: Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG; German Research Foundation) Panelist Service

- Ad-hoc panelist, Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG; German Research Foundation) Panelist Service, January 2026

Service to Profession: Workshop Organizer

- Language, Mind, and Ethics in AI: Workshops and Working Groups (co-organizer with Harvey Lederman and Mark Budolfson), 2024

Service to Profession: Workshop Steering Committee

- First Workshop on the Interplay of Model Behavior and Model Internals: A Workshop at the Conference for Language Modeling (COLM), 2025

Service to Profession: Editing

- Associate Editor, 2025-present, *Open Mind* (Guest Editor 2021-2025)
- Area Chair, 2024-present, Association for Computational Linguistics Rolling Review (ARR)
- Co-Editor (with Marten van Schijndel), Special Issue of *Journal of Memory and Language* “What can one blackbox tell us about the other?”, 2023-2026
- Editorial Board Member, *Linguistic Issues in Language Technology*, 2023-present

Service to Profession: Senior Program Committee

- Area Chair, Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING), 2024
- Area Chair, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2022
- Area Chair, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2021
- Area Chair, Association for Computational Linguistics-International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing (ACL-IJCNLP), 2021

Service to Profession: Best Paper Committee

- Member, Best Paper Committee, European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL), 2026

Service to Profession: Ad-hoc grant reviewing since 2020

British Academy/Wolfson Research Professorships; National Science Foundation Linguistics; National Science Foundation Education and Human Resources (EHR); French National Research Agency (ANR); Marsden Fund of the Royal Society Te Apārangi, New Zealand; Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG; German Research Foundation) Grant; Swiss National Science Foundation; Czech Science Foundation

Service to Profession: Journal Peer Reviewer since 2020

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Science, Science Advances, Nature Human Behavior, Psychological Science, PLoS One, Glossa, Cognition, Topics in Cognitive Science, Current Directions in Psychology, Synthese, Journal of Memory and Language, Open Mind, Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition, Cognitive Science, Entropy, Linguistic Issues in Language Technology, inter alia

Service to Profession: Program Committee (Reviewer) since 2020

ACL Rolling Review (ARR), Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), North American Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL), European Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL), Big Picture Workshop 2023, CogSci, Human Sentence Processing Conference, NeurIPS, Society for Computing in Linguistics (SCiL), International Congress of Linguists

Service to Profession: Ethics Reviewer

- Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2022-2024

Service to Profession: Professional Memberships

Association for Computational Linguistics
Linguistic Society of America